

Alejandro Gil Rivera

AI & Innovation Ecosystem Consultant

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About

Consultant and practitioner with 10+ years of experience across startup ecosystems, international development organizations, and agricultural technology in Latin America. Combines direct experience as a **startup founder** (EU-funded, accelerator alumni), **operations leader** in technology companies, and **research project manager** for IDH and Conservation International — with active practice building AI automation systems, intelligent agents, and data pipelines for agricultural operations and SMBs. Member of three of the most traction-generating **AI communities in Latin America and the Caribbean**. Unique dual perspective as both a smallholder coffee producer in Caldas, Colombia and an AI systems builder, offering authentic first-hand insight into how AI is transforming startups, ecosystem support organizations, and investment dynamics across ALC.

Experience

Jun 2024–Mar 2025 **Information System Consultant, IDH & Conservation International – HYLEA**, Huila, Colombia

- Design and development of the HYLEA Information System (sihylea.com) for the Andean-Amazonian Corridor Pact, supporting sustainable coffee and cacao value chains across multiple municipalities in Huila.
- **Methodological framework design** and primary data collection local organizations and ecosystem support actors.
- Construction of **analytical framework**: taxonomies, monitoring indicators, and data governance matrices for multi-stakeholder coordination (IDH, Conservation International, municipalities, cooperatives).
- Delivered user manuals, sustainability plan, and bi-weekly follow-up documentation aligned with contractual deliverables.

Nov 2024–Mar 2025 **Project Leader, IDH – LATTE Program**, Colombia

- Leadership in designing **climate financing mechanisms** for coffee producers across Latin America; research on financial products for smallholders implementing climate-resilient practices.
- Development of **data-driven decision tools** for assessing climate resilience needs and agricultural adaptation strategies at farm level.

Jun 2024–Mar 2025 **Data Project Manager, Colcocoa**, Colombia

- Implementation of **data capture and traceability systems** for 50+ hectare cacao and agroforestry plantation; multi-team coordination for operational efficiency.

Mar 2021–Present **Financial Officer (Co-founder), Power Compost**, Colombia

- Co-founder of circular economy **climate action startup**; secured and managed **\$120K+ USD in EU grants** (Climate KIC, GIZ) for sustainability initiatives.
- Participant in **Catalyst acceleration program** (Tech de Monterrey); subscription-based MVP with consistent MRR and 5% churn rate; diverted 14,000+ kg organic waste, 500+ community participants.

Aug 2019–Feb 2022 **Operations & Service Manager, Direktio S.A.S (HealthTech)**, Colombia

- Leadership of remote **startup team** of up to 7 (developers, data engineers); managed technical projects with annual budgets exceeding \$100K USD.
- Implemented **BI dashboards** (QlikView, Qlik Sense), multi-source ETL pipelines, and AWS cloud migration achieving 37% infrastructure cost reduction.
- Client relationship management for **data integration projects** with healthcare institutions in Colombia and Dominican Republic.

Apr 2022–Nov 2022 **Sustainability Projects Manager, Carryt (Logistics Tech)**, Colombia

- Implemented **blockchain-based carbon compensation** program; 60% increase in CO₂ tons compensated; sustainability loyalty program for independent drivers.

Feb 2022–Jun 2022 **Operations Director, *Saving The Amazon*, Colombia**
○ Led operational teams using Agile/SCRUM; coordinated planting of 15,000+ trees in the Colombian Amazon region.

Projects

Jan 2023–Present **Project Director & AI Systems Builder, *Bellavista Coffee*, Manizales, Colombia**
○ Operational and financial management of family coffee farm (~15 ha, 1,300 masl); transition to **regenerative agriculture** (biochar, biological control, zero agrochemicals).
○ Built end-to-end **AI automation pipelines** (n8n + Claude API + Notion) for farm data management and operational workflows; developed **AI-powered prospecting system** (Apify + n8n + Claude API) for European specialty roaster outreach.
○ First international export: Honey Castillo in German specialty marketplace (Garza Coffee, Germany); managed buyer relationships and quality certification.

2024–Present **Active Member, *AI Communities in Colombia – 3 Leading Networks***
○ Active participant in three of the most traction-generating **AI communities in Latin America and the Caribbean**, including structured training through Aztec Lab.
○ Roles include solution co-creation, **AI agent development** (Claude API, MCP integrations, n8n), knowledge sharing, and building applied AI use cases for agriculture and SMBs.

Education

2026 **Inteligencia Artificial - Agentes, API, n8n, Aztec**, Bogotá, Colombia
2024 **Impact Investment, *Universidad de Los Andes***, Bogotá, Colombia
2019 **Transformational Leadership, *Universidad EAFIT***, Medellín, Colombia
2013 **MSc in Supply Chain Management, *EM Normandie Business School***, Le Havre, France
2010 **Bachelor in International Business, *Lindenwood University***, St. Charles, MO, USA

Skills

Research & Analysis **Primary data collection**, methodological framework design, **case study development**, impact narratives, **data visualization** (Power BI, Google Sheets, Excel/VBA)

AI & Automation Claude API, **n8n workflows**, MCP Integrations, **AI agent development**, Apify, prompt engineering, vibe coding

Project Management **Agile/SCRUM**, Asana, Notion, multi-stakeholder coordination, budgets +\$100K USD, remote team leadership

Ecosystem Networks **Startup communities**, EU funding programs (Climate KIC, GIZ), Catalyst/TecMty accelerator, IDH, Conservation International

Languages **Spanish** (native), **English** (bilingual), French (professional), Portuguese (intermediate)